Acme Consulting - Remote Work Policy

Effective Date: January 1, 2026 | Owner: People Operations | Version 3.2

1. Purpose

This policy establishes guidelines for employees working remotely, either full-time or on a hybrid schedule, to ensure consistent expectations around availability, communication, data security, and equipment across every team at Acme Consulting. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees, and does not apply to independent contractors, whose remote work terms are governed separately by their statement of work.

2. Eligibility

Employees who have completed their 90-day probationary period and whose role does not require regular physical presence on client premises are eligible to apply for a remote work arrangement. Client-facing consultants staffed on engagements that require on-site work retain a hybrid schedule determined by the engagement lead, and eligibility for those roles is reassessed at the start of each new engagement.

New hires joining in a fully remote capacity are exempt from the 90-day waiting period, provided the remote arrangement was agreed upon during the offer stage and is documented in the offer letter.

3. Core Hours and Availability

All remote employees must be available and responsive between 10:00 AM and 3:00 PM in their local time zone, regardless of which time zone they are working from. Outside of core hours, employees may structure their schedule flexibly, provided total weekly hours meet their role's expectations and any standing client meetings are attended.

Employees traveling across time zones for more than three consecutive business days should notify their manager in advance so that core-hour expectations can be temporarily adjusted.

4. Equipment and Security

The company will provide a laptop, external monitor, and VPN access for approved remote employees. All company data must remain on company-issued devices and must never be stored on personal cloud storage accounts, personal email, or removable media. Employees connecting from public Wi-Fi networks, such as those in cafes or airports, are required to use the company VPN at all times.

Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to IT Security within four hours of discovery so that device credentials can be revoked and remote wipe procedures initiated.

5. Home Office Stipend

Eligible employees may claim up to $500 per year toward home office equipment such as desks, chairs, monitor arms, and lighting, submitted through the standard expense reimbursement process with itemized receipts. Stipend claims for the current calendar year must be submitted no later than December 15, and unused stipend amounts do not roll over to the following year.

6. Performance and Review

Remote work arrangements are reviewed annually by the employee's manager as part of the standard performance cycle, and may be modified or revoked at any time if availability, communication, or performance expectations are not being met. Managers are expected to document any concerns and provide a 30-day improvement window before revoking a remote arrangement, except in cases involving a security policy violation.

7. Frequently Asked Questions

- Can I work from another country temporarily? Yes, for up to 20 business days per year with manager approval and an IT Security review of the destination country's data regulations.
- Does the home office stipend cover internet bills? No, ongoing utilities such as internet or electricity are not covered by the one-time equipment stipend.
- Who do I contact about VPN issues? IT Helpdesk, available during core hours via the internal support portal.